

Embracing the unknown is essential for innovation, resilience and realising our true potential

Humans **possess** four basic emotions – happiness, sadness, anger and fear. Each has a unique place in our lives and shapes much of our responses to situations. The unknown is probably one entity that **invokes** all four emotions and **spurs** us into action. However, it is the fear of what we **project** onto the unknown that often **paralyzes** us into inaction. Action is built into our **psyche**. We must necessarily move, even though we do not know the results of our **endeavours**.

Instead of focusing on the happiness we will **derive** from success, we let this uncertainty **bog** us **down**. We **procrastinate** terrified of failure and refuse to take the next step.

This is an all too familiar **phenomenon** that we **encounter** every day of our lives. As we start **going up** the professional **ladder**, many of us follow **time-tested formulae**, **handed down** to us by **predecessors**. We hesitate to make decisions **contrary to** the **established** norms, even though such decisions may **result in substantial** gains, within the framework of certain acceptable risks. All our efforts are guided by that one decision in 10 which did not click. We do not look at the nine that did. We forget that as a child we had no fears when we started **exploring** the universe around us.

We fell, as we tried to get on our two feet, but were encouraged, or even forced, to keep trying till we **mastered** the art of walking; or for that matter everything. We also forget that we were not **scared** to take up a job after college, even though we knew nothing about the work we had to do. We learned from our mistakes. The worst was that we failed the first time, and the best was that we succeeded **eventually**. Ah! The joy of success! We forget that humans evolved due to an **inherent** desire to explore the unknown, without a care for failure or success. New worlds were found, and new inventions and scientific discoveries were made.

All because a few dared to **venture** into the unknown. We deny ourselves the endless new opportunities that each new day brings. It is not that we do not possess this spirit. It is just that **generations** of conditioning **have** made it **dormant**, till we are in a situation **with our backs to the wall**. Nowhere is it more in evidence, than in jugaad, the flexible approach to solve a problem innovatively when one has limited resources. In our personal lives, we are told to **pursue** our dreams but are often guided towards the more tried and safer options.

We do not even try to think of the endless possibilities and the heights that society can reach if everyone is encouraged not to fear the failure of the unknown, but to think about success, and is free to follow his or her heart!

This is the **contradiction** that most of us from the earlier generation, specifically from the middle class, face when teaching the young. Fortunately for our race, the young of today are better prepared

for the unknown with the availability of much better sources of information which were also created by a few who **dared** to dream.

We should teach the young to step out in the rain without an umbrella and get **drenched**.

Let the sky be the roof. They should not regret that they might have led a better life if they had not feared the unknown. Esmeralda Santiago **sums it up** so well. "How can you know what you are capable of, if you do not embrace the unknown?"

[Practice Exercise]

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.

@mocks_wallah

Vocabulary

1. **Embrace** (verb) – Accept, adopt, welcome, receive, seize अपनाना
2. **Essential** (adjective) – Necessary, vital, crucial, important, fundamental आवश्यक
3. **Resilience** (noun) – Toughness, endurance, flexibility, adaptability, strength मजबूती
4. **Possess** (verb) – Own, have, hold, acquire, retain रखना
5. **Invoke** (verb) – Call upon, appeal to, summon, solicit, evoke आह्वान करना
6. **Spur** (verb) – Encourage, stimulate, motivate, prompt, inspire प्रेरित करना
7. **Project** (verb) – Forecast, estimate, predict, envision, portray अनुमान लगाना
8. **Paralyses** (verb) – Immobilize, freeze, incapacitate, disable, stun पंगु बनाना
9. **Psyche** (noun) – Mind, mentality, consciousness, soul, inner self मनोवृत्ति
10. **Endeavour** (noun) – Effort, attempt, venture, pursuit, undertaking प्रयास
11. **Derive** (verb) – Obtain, extract, gain, acquire, receive प्राप्त करना
12. **Bog down** (phrasal verb) – Overwhelm, entangle, hinder, obstruct, encumber फंसना
13. **Procrastinate** (verb) – Delay, postpone, defer, stall, put off टालना
14. **Phenomenon** (noun) – Occurrence, event, happening, incident, spectacle घटना
15. **Encounter** (verb) – Meet, face, confront, experience, come across सामना करना
16. **Go up the ladder** (phrase) – Advance, rise, progress, move up, ascend प्रगति करना
17. **Time-tested** (adjective) – Proven, reliable, dependable, established, trustworthy आजमाया हुआ
18. **Formulae** (noun) – Methods, procedures, techniques, approaches, recipes सूत्र
19. **Hand down** (phrasal verb) – Pass on, bequeath, transfer, convey, deliver सौंपना
20. **Predecessor** (noun) – Forerunner, precursor, ancestor, predecessor, antecedent पूर्वज
21. **Contrary to** (phrase) – Opposite to, against, conflicting with, opposed to, differing from के विपरीत
22. **Established** (adjective) – Recognized, accepted, set, confirmed, proven स्थापित
23. **Result in** (phrasal verb) – Cause, lead to, bring about, produce, create परिणामस्वरूप होना

24. **Substantial** (adjective) – Significant, considerable, major, important, noteworthy महत्वपूर्ण
25. **Explore** (verb) – Investigate, examine, search, probe, discover तलाश करना
26. **Master** (verb) – Learn, grasp, excel, command, perfect निपुण होना
27. **Scare** (verb) – Frighten, terrify, startle, intimidate, alarm डराना
28. **Eventually** (adverb) – Finally, ultimately, in the end, at last, sooner or later अंततः
29. **Inherent** (adjective) – Innate, intrinsic, natural, built-in, essential अंतर्निहित
30. **Venture into** (phrasal verb) – Undertake, embark on, experiment with, dare into, try out साहस करना
31. **Dormant** (adjective) – Inactive, sleeping, latent, resting, undeveloped निष्क्रिय
32. **With one's backs to the wall** (phrase) – In a difficult situation, cornered, trapped, under pressure मुश्किल में फंसना
33. **Pursue** (verb) – Chase, follow, seek, strive for, go after पीछा करना
34. **Contradiction** (noun) – Conflict, inconsistency, discrepancy, difference, opposition विरोधाभास
35. **Dare** (verb) – Challenge, venture, risk, take on, defy साहस करना
36. **Drenched** (adjective) – Soaked, wet, saturated, sopping, waterlogged भीगा हुआ
37. **Sum up** (phrasal verb) – Conclude, summarize, recapitulate, encapsulate, outline सारांश प्रस्तुत करना

Summary of the Editorial

1. **Emotional Response to the Unknown:** The unknown triggers core emotions like happiness, sadness, anger, and fear, often leading to action but sometimes causing paralysis due to fear.
2. **Fear-Induced Inaction:** People avoid action due to fear of failure, procrastinating instead of pursuing potential happiness and success.
3. **Professional Hesitation:** In careers, individuals rely on traditional methods, fearing risks despite potential gains, focusing on failures rather than successes.
4. **Childhood Courage:** As children, exploration was fearless, driven by curiosity and the persistence to learn despite failures.
5. **Workplace Learning:** Starting a new job after college involves embracing the unknown, learning from mistakes, and ultimately achieving success.
6. **Human Evolution through Exploration:** Humanity's progress is rooted in exploring the unknown, leading to discoveries and innovations.
7. **Missed Opportunities:** Fear of the unknown limits personal and societal growth, causing missed opportunities for progress.
8. **Conditioned Mindset:** Generational conditioning suppresses the natural spirit of exploration, surfacing only in critical situations.
9. **Jugaad Spirit:** The innovative, resourceful problem-solving mindset of jugaad reflects embracing uncertainty with creativity.
10. **Guided Choices:** Social norms often push individuals toward safer career paths, restricting dream pursuits.
11. **Potential for Societal Growth:** Societal advancement depends on embracing uncertainty and encouraging creative exploration.
12. **Generational Contradiction:** Older generations face dilemmas when guiding the youth, balancing traditional caution and modern openness to risks.
13. **Information Access:** Today's youth are better prepared due to access to abundant information, created by pioneers who embraced the unknown.
14. **Encouraging Fearlessness:** Young people should be encouraged to experience life fully, without fear of getting hurt or failing.
15. **Self-Discovery:** Embracing the unknown is essential for realizing true potential, as summed up by Esmeralda Santiago's quote: "How can you know what you are capable of, if you do not embrace the unknown?"



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